Western Cape Government
FOR YOU

Wes-Kaapse Regering

Directorate: GET Curriculum
Direktoraat: Kurrikulum AOO

BACK ON TRACK
TASK 6 EXEMPLAR

ENGLISH - GRADE 7
TERM 3-2025
WEEKS 3&4



Back on Track

TEAM READ
A DRIVE FOR ABSOLUTE LITERACY

TERM 3 CREATIVE WRITING PROJECT

Name: _____

Class: _____ **Date**: _____

Teacher: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

- Complete a project based on the literary genre, the novel / novella.
- Task 6 consists of 2 Stages: Research and Writing.
- Stage One: Research - apply your knowledge and skills to address the Hypothesis/Research Statement. (Your research findings must answer the Research Question, thereby proving/disproving the Hypothesis/Research Statement).
- Stage Two: Writing - produce an original piece of writing using the format taught in class. (Your written piece must correspond with your research).
- Your project **MUST** be completed in class.

Task	Stage	Activity	Duration	Total
Task 6	**Stage 1**	Research	Week 3 and 4	_____/20
Task 6	**Stage 2**	Writing	Week 5 and 6	_____/30

TASK 6: STAGE 1 – RESEARCH (20 marks)

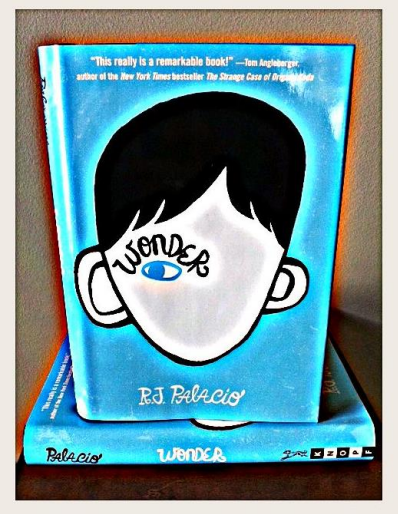
HYPOTHESIS / RESEARCH STATEMENT: The novels that engage us are those that explore THEMES with which we can identify. These stories help us to see that we are not alone - we can learn and grow by analysing the way that the characters interact with each other around the themes.

RESEARCH QUESTION / DRIVING QUESTION: Are the THEMES addressed in novels important as a means of engaging our interest and assisting our understanding of the world around us? Answer the above question with specific reference to the sources below. Source A is a summary of the novel "Wonder" by R. J. Palacio (Alfred J. Knopf, 2012). Source B is an extract from the novel.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES TO ASSIST YOU WITH YOUR RESEARCH:

1. *About the novel itself:*
   - **Kiddle** – A Google-powered, child-friendly search engine. Typing "Wonder R.J. Palacio summary" will filter out unsafe content.
   - **Kidtopia** – Curated educational search tool for learners.
   - **DK Find Out!** – While not novel-specific, learners can explore topics like kindness, empathy, and diversity, which connect to *Wonder*.
2. *About the text features of the novel:*
   - https://www.bbc.co.uk/bitesize/articles/z34pf82#zd9nydm

3. *About the author:*
   - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/R._J._Palacio





SOURCE A: SUMMARY OF THE NOVEL "Wonder", by R. J. Palacio

"Wonder" by R.J. Palacio tells the story of August "Auggie" Pullman, a boy born with a medical condition affecting his facial features. Auggie doesn't look like other kids, even after having many operations to help him. Because of his poor health, his parents decide to homeschool him for the first few years of primary school. This means that he has very limited contact with other kids his age. But when Auggie reaches middle school, his parents decide to send him to a mainstream school in the area.

At the beginning of the novel, Auggie is terrified of going to a 'normal' school. He knows that he looks very different to the other learners and feels that he will be treated like a freak. The novel allows us to journey with Auggie through his first year at Beecher Prep School. Along the way, he learns very powerful lessons, including dealing with bullying and understanding what true friendship means.

The characters in the novel, including Auggie's sister, Via, his friends, Jack and Summer, and the bully, Julian, who targets Auggie at school, all play important roles in Auggie's development. He faces huge challenges, but through his experiences with others, he finally learns to accept himself as he is and finds his place in the world.

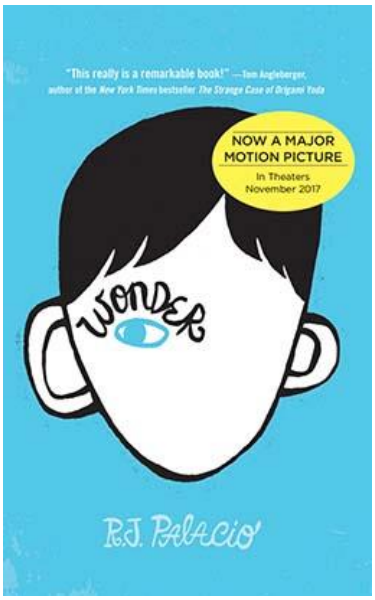
"Wonder" shows us how important it is to be kind to others and to show compassion even when it's difficult. It also highlights the issue of prejudice and why we need to look beyond physical appearances. By the end of the novel, we can clearly see that as human beings, we are all connected. There is no power greater than love – both

of ourselves and of others. Far too often, the way we see ourselves is influenced by how others treat us. Auggie's story teaches us that we need to find our own identities, and be true to ourselves.

(Adapted from ChatGPT)

SOURCE B: EXTRACT from "Wonder", by R. J. Palacio

''I know I'm not an ordinary ten-year-old kid. I mean, sure, I do ordinary things. I eat ice cream. I ride my bike. I play ball. I have an XBox. Stuff like that makes me ordinary. I guess, And I feel ordinary. Inside. But I know ordinary kids don't make other ordinary kids run away screaming in playgrounds. I know ordinary kids don't get stared at wherever they go.



If I found a magic lamp and I could have one wish, I would wish that I had a normal face that no one ever noticed at all. I would wish that I could walk down the street without people seeing me and then doing that look-away thing. Here's what I think: the only reason I'm not ordinary is that no one else sees me that way.
But I'm kind of used to how I look by now. I know how to pretend I don't see the faces people make. We've all gotten pretty good at that sort of thing: me, Mom and Dad, Via. Actually, I take that back:

Via's not so good at it. She can get really annoyed when people do something rude. Like, for instance, one time in the playground some older kids made some noises. I don't even know what the noises were exactly because I didn't hear them myself, but Via heard and she just started yelling at the kids. That's the way she is. I'm not that way. Via doesn't see me as ordinary. She says she does, but if I were ordinary, she wouldn't feel like she needs to protect me as much. And Mom and Dad don't see me as ordinary, either. They see me as extraordinary. I think the only person in the world who realizes how ordinary I am is me.

My name is August, by the way. I won't describe what I look like. Whatever you're thinking, it's probably worse.''

(Palacio, 2012: 3)

RESEARCH : ANSWER THE SUB-QUESTIONS BELOW, USING SOURCES A AND B ABOVE TO SUPPORT YOUR ANSWERS.

1. What does **'theme'** mean when referring to the **novel genre?** Provide a good explanation in your own words.

2. Is it possible for a novel to have **more than one theme**? Write down a **reason** for your answer, using **Source A.**

3. Read **Source B** very carefully. Identify **at least two themes** which are being addressed by the author in the extract.

4. For **each of your two answers** above, **motivate** by **quoting** from the **extract**. Remember that your answers MUST be supported with text-based evidence! (Write good, full sentences, and pay attention to punctuation when quoting from the text).

5. In your opinion, are these themes relevant in our modern world? **Motivate your opinion.**

6.Connecting with your **own experience**: Which theme means the most to you? Explain **why** this is so, in your own words.

7. Using **Source A,** which **two** characters represent the **protagonist** and the **antagonist?**

8. In **Source A**, we are told that Auggie's parents decide to send him to school. Why do you think this is?

9. What can we infer about the relationship between Auggie and Via from **Source B?**

10. How does Auggie's **self-image** change during the novel? Refer to **Source A and Source B** to support your answer.

11. After reading the novel, do you **agree OR disagree** with the **hypothesis/research statement**?

Answer in a short paragraph, using your own words. Did the story hold your interest? Why? / Why not?

12. If asked to represent the **MAIN THEME** of the novel "Wonder" in the form of a **SLOGAN**, what

would it be? **Write** and **illustrate** your slogan in the space provided.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

1. **Compile** your bibliography**.** Consult your **bibliography checklist**.

My Bibliography …		
1. is written in alphabetical order.		
2. the author's surname is followed by a comma.		
3. the author's initial is followed by a full stop.		
4. contains the year in which the book was published and is followed by a full stop.		
5. the title is underlined and has a full stop at the end.		
6. the city in which the publisher is located is followed by a colon.		
7. the name of the publisher is followed by a full stop.		
8. Internet resources contain the name of the web page, the web address and the date when it was accessed.		

Use the **checklist** below to make sure your research is complete.

SENIOR PHASE RESEARCH CHECKLIST		
No.	**Action completed**	✓
1	The hypothesis, research question and sub-questions were given by the educator and flow from the chosen genre.	
2	I used sufficient sources to do thorough research.	
3	I used graphic organisers to summarise / organise my research notes.	
4	I used a variety of different sources.	
5	My information is well and logically organised.	
6	I acknowledged the sources that I used and put the information into my own words.	
7	I answered the sub-questions that examine the genre corresponding to the instructions given.	
8	I have compiled a bibliography.	
COMMENTS:		
SIGNATURES: Learner: _____ Teacher: _____		Date: _____

Your research will be assessed according to the rubric below.

RESEARCH RUBRIC

Criteria	5	4	3	2	1
Language Use	Learner demonstrates excellent use of vocabulary. Great syntax and use of language. Spelling and punctuation predominantly correct.	Learner demonstrates an extensive vocabulary, mostly correct syntax, language use, spelling and punctuation.	Learner demonstrates an average vocabulary, satisfactory syntax, use of language, spelling and punctuation.	Learner demonstrates limited use of vocabulary. General correct syntax, use of language, spelling and punctuation.	Learner demonstrates poor use of vocabulary, sentence structure, use of language and spelling and punctuation.
	5	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**
Acquisition and access to information. **Proof of a bibliography.**	Learner is able to independently use different types of media to obtain information. There is proof of a correct bibliography.	Able to obtain information independently. Uses different types of media. There is evidence of a mostly correct bibliography.	Able to obtain mostly information independently. There is evidence of a reasonable bibliography.	Learner is only able to acquire a limited amount of information. There is evidence of a defective bibliography.	Learner is unable to access independently. There is partial/no evidence of a bibliography.
	5	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**
Accuracy and relevance of selected information. **Organising information and developing an argument.**	Learner is able to select relevant information at a high level, synthesize information, integrate it and summarize it. This leads to the logical development of a reasoned argument.	Learner is able to select relevant information well, synthesise information at a reasonable level, integrate it and summarize it. This leads to the logical development of an argument.	Learner is able to satisfactorily select relevant information, synthesize information, integrate it and summarize it. This leads to reasonable logical development of an argument.	Learner is able to select information satisfactorily, to create a product that shows partial evidence of synthesis of information. It is not logical and coherent throughout. The argument is not always reasoned.	Information is inaccurate and irrelevant. Learner is unable to produce any information. The product is incoherent, illogical and lacks evidence of a reasoned argument.
	5	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**
Presentation of findings.	Learner is able to present findings clearly, structured and concisely through a variety of appropriate presentation styles.	Learner is able to present findings clearly, reasonably structured and concisely through appropriate presentation styles.	Learner is able to present findings fairly structured through presentation styles.	Learner is able to present the findings. Structure and clarity are lacking.	Learner is not able to present the findings in a logical, structured way.

TOTAL: _____ / 20

Comments:

_____

Teacher: _____ **Date:** _____